

BITWIG STUDIO CONTROLLER EXTENSION

Native Instruments **NKS Connect**



Setup and Functions

This document gives you a brief overview of NKS Connect with Bitwig Studio. For an in-depth explanation of NKS Connect and all supported controllers, please read the NKS Connect documentation on the Native Instruments website.

What is NKS Connect?

NKS Connect brings NKS browsing and control experience to supported MIDI controllers. With the help of the NKS Connect app, you get hands-on control of NKS instruments in Native Instruments Kontakt, Komplete Kontrol, and Maschine.

NKS works **alongside existing controller extensions**. When an NKS-compatible plug-in is loaded on the selected track, NKS mode gives you hardware-based browsing, mapped parameter control, parameter feedback, and visual feedback on the controller display and LEDs. Where supported, the controller reflects the selected track or instrument color, helping you identify the active sound or plug-in from the hardware.

Setup

Please make sure you have updated your controller to the latest firmware.

To download and install the NKS Connect App, connect your controller to your computer and open Native Access. Make sure that *NKS Connect* app and *Hardware Connection Service* are properly installed.

When your NKS compatible MIDI controller is connected, a virtual MIDI port called *NKS Connect* is created. Bitwig Studio will detect this port and set up the NKS Connect extension automatically. In case you add the extension manually, make sure to use these MIDI ports:

Mac/Windows:

In: NKS Connect
Out: NKS Connect

Important: To be able to use NI Komplete Kontrol software please go to Dashboard > Settings > Plug-ins and set the Plug-in Hosting Mode to *By manufacturer* (recommended), *Together*, or *Within Bitwig*.

AKAI MPK Mini IV

Taking the AKAI MPK Mini IV as an example, these additional functions* are available with the NKS Connect extension (on tracks with an NKS plug-in).

1 Toggle NKS Mode

Press PLUGIN/DAW to toggle the controller between normal and NKS mode.

2 Browse and Preview NKS Presets

Turn the Encoder to browse through NKS presets and preview them.

Push the Encoder to load a preset.

3 Browse NKS Presets

Press - or + to load the previous or next NKS preset.

4 Plug-in Parameters

The 8 encoders control parameters premapped in the NKS plug-in.



**NKS Connect does not replace the standard extension for your controller, both should be active at the same time.*

To use your MPK Mini IV, please make sure that the AKAI MPK Mini IV extension is properly set up and activated.